

Sara lives in London

Phonics focus

- One sound to one letter, e.g. consonants /l/ /m/ /f/ /v/ /t/
- One sound to two letters, e.g. 'th' /θ/ with, three and 'ch' /tʃ/ in children
- Short vowel sound/letter correspondence, e.g. in, at, bed
- Long vowel sound spelt with two letters 'oo' /u:/ room

Materials

- [Pictures](#) of Sara and her flat from the 'New to ESOL' materials, Topic 1, Unit 1 'My life now' (New to ESOL topic 1, Me) plus pictures of a bedroom, a family and children.
- [Word cards from Topic 1, Unit 1.](#) Create additional word cards as required: Sara / lives / in / London / a / flat / has / three / bedrooms/ with / her / family / She / children / . /
- [Letter and grapheme cards](#): cards with alphabet letters and individual graphemes (see Templates 8 and 9, and 'Introduction to Phonics' section)
- [Text](#) (p.5)
- [Sentence strips](#) (from Topic 2, Unit 4)
- [Template 12](#) - phoneme chart (for support)
- Sticky notes and mini whiteboards

Warmer

Introduce the topic: refer to 'New to ESOL' materials **Topic 1, Unit 1** and discuss where the learners live and who they live with.

Suggested procedure

1. Show the pictures, check vocabulary, drill key words and elicit/tell the story orally (Text p.5), checking understanding as you do so. Ask learners to re-tell the story. Focus on comprehension.
2. Hold up key word cards (e.g. flat, bedroom, family, children), drill – focus on pronunciation - and check understanding. Ask learners to match the word cards with the correct pictures.
3. Now show the text and read it aloud slowly, pointing to each word as you say it. This is a much more careful pronunciation than normal speech. Note that some of the words are 'tricky' words so teach these as whole words: *the, she, lives, her*.
4. Read the text aloud again, pointing to each word, breaking down the longer words into syllables and saying them carefully, e.g. *chil – dren, fam – i – ly, bed – rooms, Lon – don*. Encourage learners to clap or tap the syllables as you say them. Point to short, simple words such as *with, in, flat* and model sounding them out, e.g. f – l – a – t.
5. Then slowly read the text aloud with the learners (choral reading). Ask for volunteers to read it aloud, pointing to the words as they say them. Give each learner a copy of

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the text to practise reading aloud – in pairs or individually. Monitor, support and concept check as necessary.

6. At any point during the reading of the text, focus on phonics: point to a simple word and sound it out or ask a learner to sound it out, e.g. 'h – a – s' 'f – l – a – t'.
7. Focus on an initial or final grapheme and elicit the sound, e.g. 'l' in *lives*, 'b' in *bedrooms*, 'sh' in *she*, 'n' in *London* and *children*.
8. Initially focus on short vowel sounds in simple words such as *with*, *in*, *flat*, *bed*
9. Practise blending consonants, e.g. 'fl' in *flat*, 'thr' in *three*
10. Choose phonics practice activities suitable for your learners and use pictures to support vocabulary development.

Activity 1: Say the words slowly with the learners and ask them to select or copy the missing letters.

Activity 2: Learners read aloud the words/sentences and put in the missing letters.

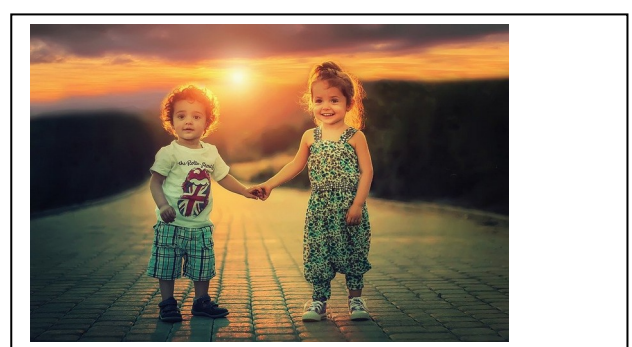
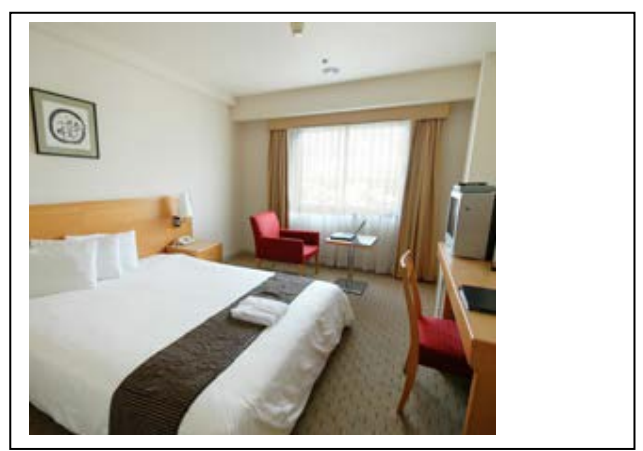
Activity 3: Word boxes: learners say the vowel letters (short sounds plus 'oo') and fill in the gaps. With *flat*, *bed*, and *room* elicit other known words which rhyme and/or have the same sound/spelling pattern, e.g. *cat*, *sat*, *fat*; *red*, *fed*, *led*; *soon*, *moon*, *food*, *boot*.

Further phonics practice activities

- Choose a one-syllable word (suitable for your learners) and put each grapheme on a sticky note – say the sounds as you build the word, e.g. i – n, f – l – a – t, w – i – th, b – e – d.
- Make puzzles with one grapheme on each sticky note, e.g. sh e ch i l d r e n and ask learners to assemble them into words. Make sure you/the learners say the sounds as they put the words together.
- Handout copies of the text. Learners listen and highlight/underline the graphemes as you say them, e.g. 'ch' and 'sh'
- Learners listen and write (or choose) the graphemes as you sound them out: f – l – a – t, b – e – d – r – oo – m – s, w – i – th, h – a – s
- Elicit other words which rhyme or with same sound/letter pattern and build up a list on the board, e.g. l – ive, g – ive; i – n, i – t, i – s; fl – at, h – at, th – at, s – at, c – at, etc. Use pictures for support. (Caution: focus on one sound/letter pattern at a time otherwise it could be confusing!)
- Work on syllables, e.g. child – ren, fam – i – ly, bed – rooms, Lon – don. Learners say words slowly as they break them down into syllables. Note the schwa in *children*, *family*. Create sticky note puzzles based on the syllables.
- Use mini-whiteboards for phoneme, grapheme or spelling practice
- Use *Resource 1.1.6* Sentence strips for learners to write simple sentences using the new words.
- Ask learners to use the new words to write simple texts about themselves.

For more suggestions, see the 'Introduction to Phonics' section.

Sara lives in London



Images from New to ESOL materials

Free images from <https://pixabay.com/images/search/children/>

Sara	lives
flat	family
three	bedroom
children	London

Sara lives in London

Sara lives in London.

She lives in a flat.

The flat has three bedrooms.

She lives with her family.

She has three children.

Activity 1 - words

...ives

...ondon

f...at

chi...dren

l

L

l

l

l...ves

...n

w...th

fam...ly

i

i

i

i

Activity 2 - sentences

i

Sara l...ves ...n London.

She l...ves ...n a flat.

The flat has three bedrooms.

She l...ves w...th her fam...ly.

She has three ch...ldren.

I

Sara ...ives in ...ondon.

She ...ives in a f...at.

The f...at has three bedrooms.

She ...ives with her fami...y.

She has three chi...dren.

Sara lives i... Lo...do....

She lives i... a fla....

The fla... has three ...e...rooms.

She lives ...ith her ...a...ily.

She has three childre...

n n n n t t b d w f m n

Activity 3 – word boxes

a i a a i e oo

f	l		t			
w		th				
h		s				
f		m	i	l	y	
ch		l	d	r	e	n
b		d	r		m	s

Now choose a word and create your own word box.
